



LME KNITTING PATTERN

🇳🇴 NORWAY BUCKET HAT 🇳🇴

THE LETTERS EMBROIDERED ON (DUPLICATE STITCH)

A summer hat in red cotton with "NORGE" in big white block letters on the front, and "RO" with waves at the back. You knit the whole hat in red with a striped edge at the bottom, and embroider NORGE and RO on at the end in duplicate stitch. One size in stitches, and the needle sets the width, so it fits from teens to adults. A lovely summer hat for the 17th of May and everything we celebrate for Norway.

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TIP: Read the whole pattern through once before you start, and knit a little gauge swatch first. Then the hat comes out exactly the right size.

BEFORE YOU START

This hat is knitted round and round on a circular needle, from the bottom up. You begin with the striped edge in white and navy blue, decrease to 110 stitches, knit straight up in red and finally bind off the top together. The letters NORGE, RO and the waves you embroider on at the very end. That is called duplicate stitch, and it is much easier than it looks.

WHAT YOU LEARN

- To knit in the round on a circular needle
- To knit a striped edge and decrease evenly
- To knit stripes in several colours
- To bind off stitches so the top comes out nicely rounded
- To embroider with duplicate stitch, stitches that look like knitted stitches

HOW HARD IS IT?

Beginner plus. You should be able to cast on stitches, knit, and knit two stitches together. Everything else is explained step by step. Feel free to ask a grown-up for help the first time you join the circular needle or change to double-pointed needles.

ONE SIZE, THE NEEDLE SETS THE WIDTH

This hat has the **same stitch count for everyone**. You cast on 130 and decrease to 110 stitches. It is the **needle** that sets how big the hat turns out:

needle 3 mm → S/M · needle 3.5 mm → L · needle 4 mm → XL

A thinner needle gives a smaller, firmer hat, a thicker needle a bigger one. Size L on a 3.5 mm needle is the one we have measured. Tip: Always knit a gauge swatch first, then you know your needle gives the right width.

One step at a time, and it becomes a hat in the end.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

DROPS Paris (100% cotton, 50 g = approx. 75 m). A thick, soft cotton yarn. For this hat we knit it firmly, on a 3 to 4 mm needle, so the hat keeps its shape nicely.

Colour	Amount
● Red (main colour)	2 to 3 balls
○ White or natural	1 ball
● Navy blue	1 ball

You can also use another thick cotton yarn (the same weight as DROPS Paris), for example Hobbii Rainbow Cotton 8/8. We knit it firmer than the label says, so the hat holds its shape. Always check your gauge!

NEEDLES AND EQUIPMENT

- **circular needle 3.5 mm**, 60 cm long (the whole hat is knitted on this). Use 3 mm for S/M and 4 mm for XL.
- **double-pointed needles** in the same size for the top, when it gets too tight on the circular needle
- A pair of needles one size up or down if needed, so you hit the right width after the gauge swatch
- A **stitch marker** (or a little loop of yarn in another colour)
- A **tapestry needle with a blunt tip** for the embroidery and weaving in ends
- Tape measure and scissors

GAUGE, THE SECRET KEY

On a 3.5 mm needle (size L), 20 stitches and about 26 rows of stockinette should make 10 × 10 cm. We knit the yarn firmer than usual, so the hat stands up well.

Here is how you check: Cast on 24 stitches and work stockinette (back and forth: one row knit, one row purl) until the swatch is about 12 cm tall. Lay the swatch flat and measure how many stitches there are over 10 cm in the middle.

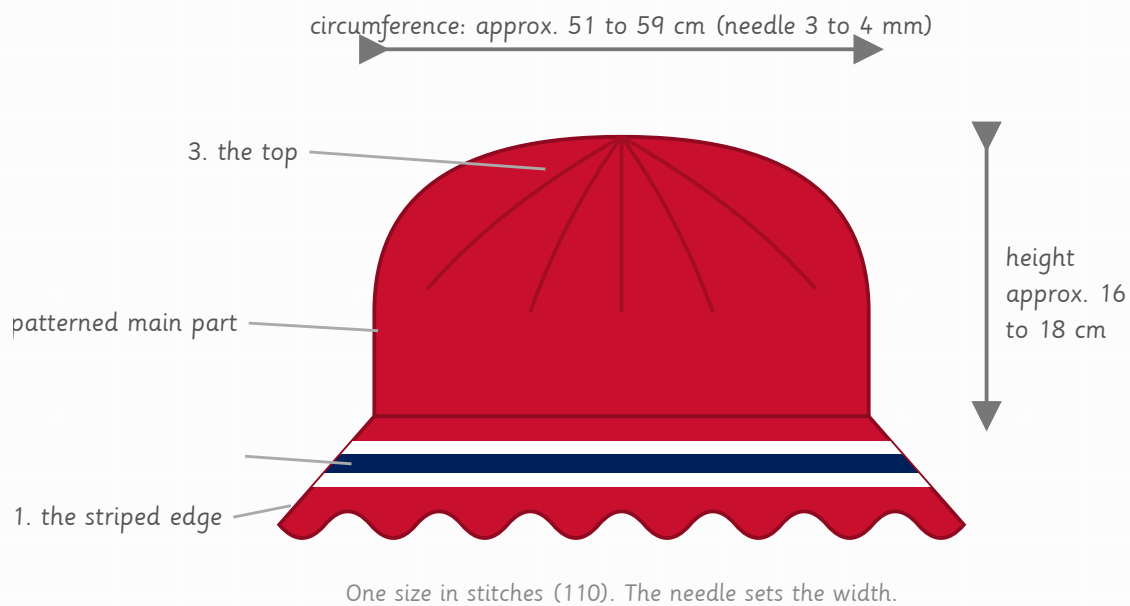
- Want it smaller (S/M)? Use a 3 mm needle.
- Want it bigger (XL)? Use a 4 mm needle.
- Hit 20 stitches on 3.5 mm? Perfect, that is size L, get going!

SIZES AND MEASUREMENTS

WHICH SIZE?

Measure around the head with a tape measure, just above the ears and eyebrows. Choose the needle that gives the circumference to match the head. The hat should be 3 to 4 cm smaller than the head, because knitting stretches. All the sizes have 110 stitches, it is the needle that makes the difference.

	S/M (3 mm)	L (3,5 mm)	XL (4 mm)
Fits head size	52-55 cm	56-59 cm	59-62 cm
Circumference of the hat	approx. 51 cm	approx. 55 cm	approx. 59 cm
Height (without brim)	approx. 16 cm	approx. 17 cm	approx. 18 cm
Stitches in the main part	110	110	110



Unsure about the size? Choose a slightly thicker needle, a bucket hat looks good sitting a little loose.

GLOSSARY

Term	Means
st	stitch
round	one whole round all the way around the hat
k	knit, ordinary knit stitches
k2tog	put the needle through two stitches at once and knit them as one. That gives one stitch fewer.
cast on	make the first stitches on the needle
bind off	reduce the number of stitches, so the hat gets narrower
stockinette in the round	when you knit in the round and knit every round, it comes out smooth and neat. Easier than knitting a hat back and forth!
duplicate stitch	embroidery that lies on top of the stitches and looks knitted

HOW THE HAT IS BUILT UP

- 1 The striped edge:** You cast on 130 stitches in red and knit a striped edge: red, white, blue, white, red. On the last red round you decrease to 110 stitches.
- 2 The stripes:** white, navy blue and white, like a little nod to the flag.
- 3 The main part:** just knit round and round. Here you can almost knit with your eyes closed.
- 4 The top:** You decrease evenly at ten places, so the top comes out round as a bowl.
- 5 The embroidery:** At the end you embroider "NORGE" on the front and "RO" with waves at the back, in duplicate stitch.

PART 1: THE STRIPED EDGE

Now we begin! The whole edge is knitted, that is, stockinette in the round. You knit a striped edge in the colours of the flag, and finally decrease to 110 stitches.

- 1 Cast on **130 st** in red on a 3.5 mm circular needle (3 mm for S/M, 4 mm for XL).
- 2 Place the stitch marker on the needle. It shows where the round starts, and it ends up at the centre back of the hat.
- 3 Lay the knitting on the table and check that the cast-on edge is not twisted around the needle. All the stitches should point the same way, like a straight railway track. Then knit the first stitch, now the ring is closed!
- 4 **The striped edge:** knit round in this order: **3 rounds red, 2 rounds white, 3 rounds navy blue, 2 rounds white**, and finally **3 rounds red**. When you change colour, just let the old yarn rest on the back.
- 5 **The decrease round (the very last red round):** Knit ***k5, k2tog*** ten times, then ***k4, k2tog*** ten times. Now you have **110 stitches**, and the edge is done.

Dropped a stitch? Take it easy. Put the needle back in and lift it up, or ask a grown-up for help. Nothing is ruined.

CHECKPOINT

- Do you have 110 stitches on the needle after the decrease round?
- Can you see the stripes: white, blue, white, with red above and below?
- Is the edge finished? Then you are ready for part 2!

PART 2: THE MAIN PART

- 1 Carry on with red and knit round and round, without binding off anything.
- 2 Knit until the main part measures **about 9 cm** from the striped edge. Measure from the edge up to the needle. That leaves good room for the embroidery.

PART 3: THE TOP

Now the hat gets narrower and narrower, until it closes at the top. You decrease at ten places on each decrease round. After decrease rounds 1, 2, 3 and 4 you knit one plain round without decreasing. From decrease round 5 you decrease on every round.

Decrease round	What to do	Left
1 (rnd 7)	*k9, k2tog* all the way around	100
	1 plain round, no decrease	100
2	*k8, k2tog*	90
	1 plain round	90
3	*k7, k2tog*	80
	1 plain round	80
4	*k6, k2tog*	70
	1 plain round	70
5	*k5, k2tog*	60
6	*k4, k2tog*	50
7	*k3, k2tog*	40
8	*k2, k2tog*	30
9	*k1, k2tog*	20
10	*k2tog* all the way around	10

The stars mean: Repeat what is between them, all the way around. When it gets too tight on the circular needle, divide the stitches onto three or four double-pointed needles and knit on exactly as before.

- 1 Cut the yarn, but leave about 30 cm. — 7 —

PART 4: THE EMBROIDERY IN DUPLICATE STITCH

Look closely at your knitting: Each stitch looks like a little V. With duplicate stitch you lay a new V in another colour on top. One square in the chart is one stitch on the hat. Use the tapestry needle with a blunt tip and a length of yarn about 50 cm long.

HOW TO MAKE ONE STITCH

1

come up here



Bring the needle up from below, at the base of the stitch (the root of the V).

2

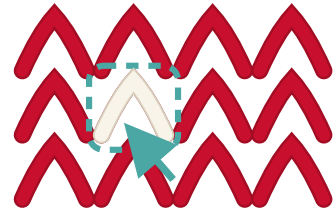
under the stitch above



Pass the needle under both legs of the stitch right above. Pull the yarn through.

3

down the same hole



Put the needle down the same hole you came up. Done! The white V now lies on top of the red stitch.

GOOD ADVICE

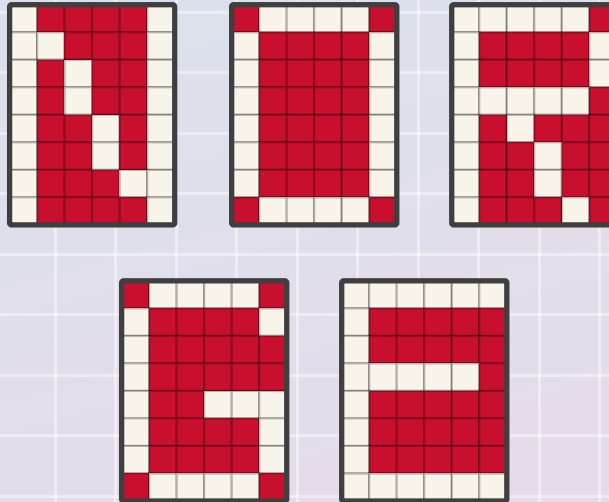
- Do not pull the yarn tight. The V should lie loose and lazy on top of the stitch, like a cat in the sun.
- Embroider row by row: finish one horizontal row in the chart before you move further up.
- Start and end by leaving 5 cm of yarn hanging on the inside. Weave in the ends when you are done.
- Count the squares in the chart and the stitches on the hat with your finger, twice if you like. Counting right is half the job!

A stitch gone wrong? Just gently pull it out again and try once more.

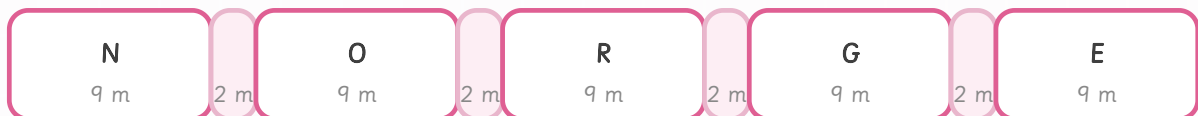
CHART: NORGE ON THE FRONT

One square = one stitch. White square = embroider with white. Red square = let the red hat show through. NORGE is embroidered around the front in big block letters. Embroider row by row from the bottom up. Each letter is 9 squares wide and 11 squares tall.

THE LETTERS (9 SQUARES WIDE, 11 SQUARES TALL)



WHERE ON THE HAT?



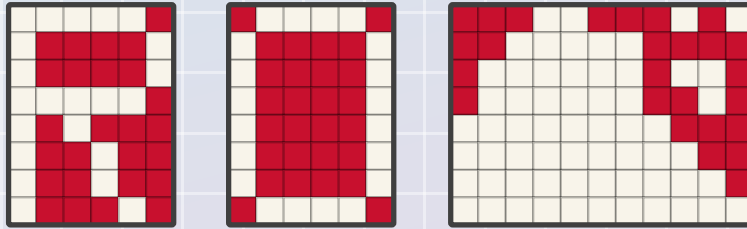
53 stitches wide in all

- **Across:** NORGE is centred at the front (directly opposite the stitch marker, which is at centre back). The word is 53 stitches wide, so it sits 26 to 27 stitches on each side of centre front. Leave 2 red stitches between each letter.
- **Up:** Embroider the bottom row of the letters about 2 cm above the striped edge. The letters fill 11 rows up. RO with waves at the back is embroidered at the same height.
- You will find the full placement around the hat on the counting strip on the next page.

CHART: RO AND WAVES AT THE BACK

At the back you embroider RO with a wave on each side. RO splits at the seam at centre back: R sits just to the right of the marker and O just to the left, so it reads RO around the back. Embroider row by row from the bottom up.

THE LETTERS AND THE WAVE



THE WHOLE ROUND, STITCH BY STITCH

½ RO: O 9 m	red 3 m	belge 11 m	red 5 m	NORGE 53 m	red 5 m	belge 11 m	red 3 m	½ RO: R 9 m	1 m
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110 stitches in all, start centre back (right end)

- **Start centre back:** The marker sits at centre back (the right end of the strip). Just to the right of the marker you embroider R (½ RO), and just to the left you embroider O. Then it reads RO around the back.
- **The waves:** one wave on each side, between RO at the back and NORGE at the front. The wave is 8 rows tall and sits in the middle of the 11-row band, with red above and below.
- Between the motifs there is only red, where the red hat shows through.

FINISHING AND CARE

RIGHT AT THE END

- 1 Weave in all loose ends on the inside of the hat: run them back and forth through the back of the stitches with the tapestry needle, and trim what is left.
- 2 Rinse the hat in lukewarm water, or wash it at 40 degrees in the machine (cotton takes it well).
- 3 Gently squeeze out the water with a towel. Do not wring!
- 4 Lay the hat flat to dry, and pat the striped edge neat while it is wet. However it dries, that is how it stays.

CHECKLIST FOR A FINISHED HAT

- All ends are woven in on the inside
- "NORGE" is on the front, "RO" and the waves at the back
- The edge is striped and the top is round
- The hat is dry and ready for summer, sea and soft ice cream

Congratulations, you have knitted your very own Norway hat!
Show it off on the 17th of May, at the cabin and in the boat.



Happy summer!

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